Detailed Documentation

Everything you need to know to operate the Waterade fleet management app day-to-day.

Overview

Waterade tracks a fleet of water dispenser machines deployed across customer sites (mostly care homes). The app gives you a single place to manage three things:

- **Customers** — the homes / locations where machines are deployed.
- **Machines** — every individual unit, identified by its serial number.
- **Service tickets** — when a machine needs intake, repair, replacement, or write-off.

The typical workflow is: a customer reports a fault → a service ticket is opened → the machine is collected → it's received at the workshop → it's verified, serviced, and either returned to the customer or written off.

Customers

Customers represent the locations that own or rent dispensers. Each customer has a unique `client_ref` (e.g. `CH108`, `OAK107`) used across the system to link machines and tickets back to a home.

Creating a new customer

1. Open the **Customers** page from the sidebar.
2. Click **Add New Customer**.
3. Fill in the home name, client reference, region (Southwest / Southeast / Midlands), and any contact details.
4. Save. The new customer is immediately available when creating tickets or assigning machines.

> For a video walkthrough of customer creation, see the Walkthrough Videos section.

Machines

Each machine is uniquely identified by a **serial number**. The system also tracks a friendly **machine number**, the **birth date**, the home it's currently deployed at, last service date, and replacement-part dates (fan, motor, condenser).

Creating a new machine

1. Go to **All Machines** from the sidebar.
2. Click **Add New Machine**.
3. Enter the serial number, machine number, birth date, and pick the initial status (e.g. `new_stock`).
4. Optionally link to a customer if it's already deployed.
5. Save.

Filtering and searching

Use the **Status Filter** and **Region Filter** at the top of the Machines page to narrow the list. Click any row's eye icon to open the machine's full detail view, including its full service history.

Fleet Kanban

The **Fleet Kanban** view (sidebar → *Fleet Kanban*) gives you a visual board of every machine grouped by its current status. Each card shows the serial number, the home it's currently at, and the time it has spent in the current state.

Use the kanban for a quick at-a-glance picture of where the fleet is bottlenecked — for example, lots of cards stuck in *With Us to Be Serviced* means intake is backed up. Click any card to jump straight into the machine's detail view.

> The kanban is a read-only overview — status changes still happen via service tickets, not by dragging cards.

Service Tickets

A service ticket is opened whenever one or more machines need attention. Tickets move through these high-level stages:

- **Open / In Transit to Us** — machine has been picked up from the customer.
- **With Us to Be Serviced** — machine has arrived at the workshop and is awaiting intake verification.
- **Being Serviced** — service has started.
- **Closed** — final state.

Receive Machines

When physical machines arrive at the workshop, click **Receive Machines** on the ticket detail page. Enter the date received and any optional remarks. This sets the ticket to *With Us to Be Serviced* and updates each linked machine.

Verify Intake

For each received machine, click **Verify Intake** to confirm the physical machine matches the record. You can add intake notes (scuffs, missing parts, etc.) before confirming. Once verified the row shows *Ready for Service*.

Generate Service Report (Draft)

For verified machines, click **Generate Service Report**. Select the service type, owner, category, location, technician, and dates. The system marks the machine as *In Service* and produces a **Draft Service Report PDF** — this is the document that is printed and handed to the service engineer along with the machine. View it any time from the **View Report** button on the machine card.

Complete Service or Write Off

From an *In Service* machine you can either **Complete Service** or **Write Off** (with a reason). When all machines on the ticket finish one of these, the ticket auto-closes.

Complete Service captures the engineer's findings into a **Final Service Report PDF**. The popup records:

- **Technician Notes** — free-text area (4 lines minimum) where the office team types up the engineer's handwritten notes from the printed Draft Report.
- **Parts Replaced** — Fan / Motor / Condenser checkboxes with replacement dates.
- **Service Completion Date**.
- **Service Photos** — multi-file upload (up to 10 images) for any pictures the engineer took during the service.
- **Completion Remarks** — optional summary.

Once submitted, the Final Report is auto-generated in the background and made available via the **View Service Report** button on the machine card.

Service Reports (Draft & Final)

Each serviced machine produces two distinct PDF reports. They serve different purposes in the workflow:

REPORT	GENERATED WHEN	PURPOSE	ACCESSED VIA
Draft Service Report	Office clicks *Generate Service Report* on a verified machine.	Printable working sheet for the service engineer. Includes ticket number, customer, machine serial & number, service type, technician, dates and service remarks. Carried with the machine for the engineer to mark up by hand with his findings, parts replaced and notes.	**View Report** button on the machine card.
Final Service Report	Office clicks *Complete Service* after the engineer returns the marked-up draft.	Permanent digital record of the completed service. Consolidates everything from the Complete Service popup — technician notes (entered by office from the engineer's paper), parts replaced with dates, completion date, completion remarks and uploaded service photos — into a single archived PDF.	**View Service Report** button on the machine card.

> **End-to-end flow:** machine arrives → intake verified → office generates & prints Draft Report → engineer services machine and writes notes on the printout → office receives the marked-up paper → office opens Complete Service popup, transcribes the engineer's notes, ticks off parts replaced, uploads photos → Final Report PDF is auto-generated and stored against the machine.

> On ticket closure, the repaired machine moves back to `in_stock` and is held in the warehouse — it is **not** automatically reissued to the original customer. The replacement that was sent out earlier stays deployed at the customer site.

Ticket Workflow & Completion

End-to-end, a service ticket moves through five concrete steps. Knowing this sequence makes it easier to spot where a ticket is stuck:

1. **Create ticket** — pick the customer, add the machines that need attention, and describe the fault.
2. **Receive Machines** — physical units arrive at the workshop; the ticket flips to *With Us to Be Serviced*.
3. **Verify Intake** — confirm each machine matches what was reported and add intake notes.
4. **Generate Service Report** — assign technician, service type and dates; a PDF service report is produced.
5. **Complete or Write Off** — close out each machine. Once every machine is closed, the ticket auto-closes. The repaired machine returns to `in_stock`; the replacement sent earlier stays deployed at the customer.

An audit log entry is recorded at each transition, so you can always trace who did what and when from the ticket detail page.

Replacement Jobs

If a machine has to be swapped out instead of repaired, you create a **Replacement Job**. A job ties one or more replacement machines to a parent service ticket and tracks the courier, tracking number, and customer-received date for each replacement.

Creating a replacement job

1. From the service ticket, click **Create Replacement Job** on a machine that's been written off or flagged for replacement.
2. Pick the replacement machine from in-stock units, set the send date, courier and tracking number.
3. Save. The replacement machine flips to *In Transit to Customer* and the original ticket is linked.
4. When the customer confirms receipt, set the **Customer Received Date** on the job — the replacement machine is then marked *Deployed*.

Rentals

Rentals cover machines deployed on a paid-rental basis instead of as outright supply. The Rentals view (sidebar → *Rentals*) shows every active and historical rental with its rate, start and end dates, and the linked customer.

Creating a rental

1. Open **Rentals** from the sidebar.
2. Click **Add New Rental**.
3. Select the customer, the machine being rented, the start date, monthly rate, and any notes.
4. Save. The machine status flips to *Deployed* and the rental row appears in the active rentals list.

Closing a rental records an end date and returns the machine to *In Stock* (or routes it through service if it needs work).

Trials

Trials are short-term loaner deployments — typically 1–4 weeks — used when a prospective customer wants to evaluate a machine before committing.

Creating a trial

1. Open **Trials** from the sidebar.

2. Click **Add New Trial**.
3. Pick the customer, machine, trial start date, expected end date, and notes (e.g. point of contact).
4. Save. The machine flips to *Trial* status and counts down to the trial end date.

At the end of the trial you can either convert it to a *Sale / Rental* (the machine stays deployed) or close the trial and recall the machine for return to stock.

Status Reference

STATUS	MEANING
new_stock	Newly received unit, never deployed.
in_stock	Available in the warehouse for assignment.
deployed	At a customer site and in active use.
in_transit_to_us	Picked up, on the way to workshop.
with_us_to_be_serviced	Arrived at workshop, awaiting service.
being_serviced	Currently being repaired.
in_transit_to_customer	Replacement machine en route to a customer site.
written_off	Permanently retired from the fleet.

> Need to see one of these flows in action? Check the Walkthrough Videos.